CHINA, COMMUNISM AND ASIA

CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN → COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES → MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY → LONG MARCH MECHANISM → WHY THE CCP WON → MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN

CHINA'S STATE-COLLAPSE CHAIN · FOREIGN PRESSURE · QING LEGITIMACY ERODES · DYNASTY FALLS · YUAN SHIKAI · REPUBLIC BECOMES MILITARY DICTATORSHIP · CENTRAL AUTHORITY FRAGMENTS

FOREIGN PRESSURE → Qing legitimacy erodes → 1911 → dynasty falls → YUAN SHIKAI → republic becomes military dictatorship → WARLORDS → central authority fragments

CORE CLAIM
- FOREIGN PRESSURE → Qing legitimacy erodes
- 1911 → dynasty falls

MECHANISM
- YUAN SHIKAI → republic becomes military dictatorship
- WARLORDS → central authority fragments

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FOREIGN PRESSURE → Qing legitimacy erodes
- 1911 → dynasty falls

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: YUAN SHIKAI → republic becomes military dictatorship; WARLORDS → central authority fragments.

01

STAGE 01

COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES

COMPETING POLITICAL ROUTES · SUN YAT-SEN · NATIONALISM, DEMOCRACY AND LIVELIHOOD · REPUBLICAN-NATIONAL STATE PROJECT · CCP 1921 · COMMUNIST ORGANISATION · ALLIANCE BREAKS INTO CIVIL WAR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood	CCP 1921 → communist organisation	SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
KMT → republican-national state project	1927 → alliance breaks into civil war	KMT → republican-national state project

CORE CLAIM
- SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
- KMT → republican-national state project

MECHANISM
- CCP 1921 → communist organisation
- 1927 → alliance breaks into civil war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SUN YAT-SEN → nationalism, democracy and livelihood
- KMT → republican-national state project

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CCP 1921 → communist organisation; 1927 → alliance breaks into civil war.

02

STAGE 02

MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY

MAO'S RURAL STRATEGY · SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT · ORTHODOX ROUTE WEAK · MASS RURAL CONSTITUENCY · LAND REFORM · MATERIAL POLITICAL CLAIM · LOCAL GOVERNING LEGITIMACY

SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak → PEASANTS → mass rural constituency → LAND REFORM → material political claim → DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

CORE CLAIM
- SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak
- PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

MECHANISM
- LAND REFORM → material political claim
- DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SMALL URBAN PROLETARIAT → orthodox route weak
- PEASANTS → mass rural constituency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND REFORM → material political claim; DISCIPLINE → local governing legitimacy.

03

STAGE 03

LONG MARCH MECHANISM

LONG MARCH MECHANISM · COMMUNIST RETREAT · LEADERSHIP PRESERVED · DOMINANCE CONSOLIDATED · RETREAT CONVERTED INTO LEGITIMACY

1934-35 → communist retreat → SURVIVAL → leadership preserved → MAO → dominance consolidated → MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CORE CLAIM
- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

MECHANISM
- MAO → dominance consolidated
- MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1934-35 → communist retreat
- SURVIVAL → leadership preserved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MAO → dominance consolidated; MEMORY → retreat converted into legitimacy.

04

STAGE 04

WHY THE CCP WON

WHY THE CCP WON · CORRUPTION, INFLATION AND POOR ADMINISTRATION · DISCIPLINE, LAND REFORM AND PEASANT CONTACT · JAPANESE WAR · KMT BURDEN RISES · MAO PROCLAIMS PRC; CHIANG RETREATS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration	JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises	KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact	1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats	CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

CORE CLAIM
- KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
- CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

MECHANISM
- JAPANESE WAR → KMT burden rises
- 1949 → Mao proclaims PRC; Chiang retreats

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- KMT → corruption, inflation and poor administration
- CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CCP → discipline, land reform and peasant contact.

05

STAGE 05

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET

MAO-ERA BALANCE SHEET · UNITY AND LANDLORD POWER WEAKENED · HUNDRED FLOWERS · CRITICISM FOLLOWED BY REPRESSION · GREAT LEAP · COMMUNES, DISRUPTION AND FAMINE · CULTURAL REVOLUTION · EDUCATION AND ADMINISTRATION DAMAGED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened	GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine	CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression	CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged	HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

CORE CLAIM
- CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
- HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

MECHANISM
- GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine
- CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CONSOLIDATION → unity and landlord power weakened
- HUNDRED FLOWERS → criticism followed by repression

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GREAT LEAP → communes, disruption and famine; CULTURAL REVOLUTION → education and administration damaged.

06

STAGE 06

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM

GREAT LEAP MECHANISM · CRASH TARGETS · ADMINISTRATIVE PRESSURE RISES · RURAL PRODUCTION REORGANISED · FEEDBACK FAILS · ERROR TRAVELS UPWARD · SEVERE DISRUPTION AND FAMINE

CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises → COMMUNES → rural production reorganised → FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward → RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CORE CLAIM
- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

MECHANISM
- FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward
- RESULT → severe disruption and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CRASH TARGETS → administrative pressure rises
- COMMUNES → rural production reorganised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEEDBACK FAILS → error travels upward; RESULT → severe disruption and famine.

07

STAGE 07

CULTURAL REVOLUTION MECHANISM

CULTURAL REVOLUTION MECHANISM · MASS CAMPAIGN · ALLEGED ENEMIES ATTACKED · CONTINUITY BROKEN · AUTHORITY DESTABILISED · SOCIAL ORDER · PROLONGED DAMAGE, 1966-76

MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked → EDUCATION → continuity broken → ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised → SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76

CORE CLAIM
- MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked
- EDUCATION → continuity broken

MECHANISM
- ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised
- SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MASS CAMPAIGN → alleged enemies attacked
- EDUCATION → continuity broken

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ADMINISTRATION → authority destabilised; SOCIAL ORDER → prolonged damage, 1966-76.

08

STAGE 08

DENG'S REFORM BOUNDARY

DENG'S REFORM BOUNDARY · DECOLLECTIVISATION AND MARKET MECHANISMS · INVESTMENT AND OPENING · ONE-PARTY RULE RETAINED · FORCE BLOCKS POLITICAL LIBERALISATION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms	POLITICS → one-party rule retained	ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
EXTERNAL → investment and opening	1989 → force blocks political liberalisation	EXTERNAL → investment and opening

CORE CLAIM
- ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
- EXTERNAL → investment and opening

MECHANISM
- POLITICS → one-party rule retained
- 1989 → force blocks political liberalisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ECONOMY → decollectivisation and market mechanisms
- EXTERNAL → investment and opening

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: POLITICS → one-party rule retained; 1989 → force blocks political liberalisation.

09

STAGE 09

ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY

ASIAN COMMUNIST DIVERSITY · NORTH KOREA · DIVISION AND EXTREME CENTRALISATION · ANTI-COLONIAL NATIONALISM PLUS COMMUNISM · KHMER ROUGE EXTREMISM · DURABLE ONE-PARTY PRAGMATIC ADJUSTMENT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation	CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism	NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism	LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment	VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

CORE CLAIM
- NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
- VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

MECHANISM
- CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism
- LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NORTH KOREA → division and extreme centralisation
- VIETNAM → anti-colonial nationalism plus communism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAMBODIA → Khmer Rouge extremism; LAOS → durable one-party pragmatic adjustment.

10

STAGE 10

SINO-SOVIET SPLIT

SINO-SOVIET SPLIT · TREATY OF FRIENDSHIP AND ASSISTANCE · AFTER 1956 · DOCTRINE, AID AND TERRITORY DIVIDE · CHINA ATTACKS SOVIET-ALIGNED VIETNAM · FORMAL RECONCILIATION IN BEIJING

1950 → treaty of friendship and assistance → AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide → 1979 → China attacks Soviet-aligned Vietnam → 1989 → formal reconciliation in Beijing

CORE CLAIM
- 1950 → treaty of friendship and assistance
- AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide

MECHANISM
- 1979 → China attacks Soviet-aligned Vietnam
- 1989 → formal reconciliation in Beijing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1950 → treaty of friendship and assistance
- AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AFTER 1956 → doctrine, aid and territory divide.

11

STAGE 11

CHINA ANSWER SPINE

CHINA ANSWER SPINE · DYNASTY FALLS WITHOUT A FUNCTIONING STATE · RURAL ORGANISATION OUT-GOVERNS KMT · UNITY PLUS SELF-GENERATED CATASTROPHE · MARKETS WITHOUT DEMOCRACY; BLOC FRACTURES

CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state → VICTORY → rural organisation out-governs KMT → MAO → unity plus self-generated catastrophe → REFORM → markets without democracy; bloc fractures

CORE CLAIM
- CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state
- VICTORY → rural organisation out-governs KMT

MECHANISM
- MAO → unity plus self-generated catastrophe
- REFORM → markets without democracy; bloc fractures

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state
- VICTORY → rural organisation out-governs KMT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CRISIS → dynasty falls without a functioning state.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · LOWE ARGUES IN EFFECT THAT MAO GAVE CHINA UNITY · BUT AT A HUGE HUMAN AND INSTITUTIONAL COST WHEN · DENG ALLOWED MARKET INCENTIVES, FOREIGN INVESTMENT AND AGRICULTURAL DECOLLECTIVIZATION. · ECONOMIC PRAGMATISM REPLACED PERMANENT MASS CAMPAIGN POLITICS. · YET THE COMMUNIST PARTY REMAINED THE UNQUESTIONED POLITICAL CENTRE. · TIANANMEN IN 1989 PROVED THAT ECONOMIC OPENING DID NOT · THIS IS A CLASSIC UPSC CONTRAST

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Lowe argues in effect that Mao gave China unity, independence and revolutionary purpose,
- but at a huge human and institutional cost when campaigns displaced administrative rationality.
- Deng allowed market incentives, foreign investment and agricultural decollectivization.
- Economic pragmatism replaced permanent mass campaign politics.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- Yet the Communist Party remained the unquestioned political centre.
- Tiananmen in 1989 proved that economic opening did not mean acceptance of organized political opposition.
- CAUTION: This is a classic UPSC contrast: marketization inside a one-party Leninist shell .
- Communist victory in China transformed the balance of power in Asia.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: For India, the relevant sequence is: 1949 PRC - 1954 Panchsheel - 1962 border war - long-term strategic caution .
- CAUTION: Do not re-narrate India's China policy here; cross-link it.
- 20-23 October 2025: the official communique of the CCP's Fourth Plenary Session said the meeting adopted recommendations for
- the Fifteenth Five-Year Plan and continued to frame policy around high-quality development, technological capacity and centralized Party leadership.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels